# We Called It an **Experiment**

*Two Perspectives on SRE in the Enterprise*

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# *This is not a tech-talk*

It’s about an experiment.

It’s about trust.

It’s about surprises.

*The problem: Ops Overload*

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Org from scratch | Drowned in ops work | Keep product in the team | Alternatives -> friction |

*The idea: An experiment introducing SRE*

## *Trust first*

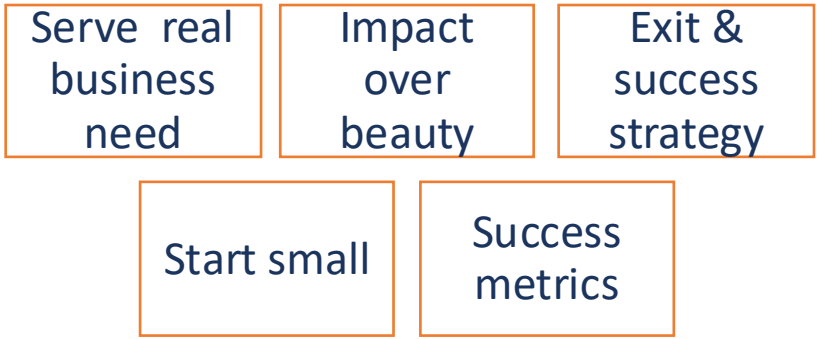
I had to start seeing the organization as a system — and earn its trust — before I could ask for the experiment.

# *The experiment*

**Hypothesis**

A tiny SRE function makes a difference

***Experiment Design***



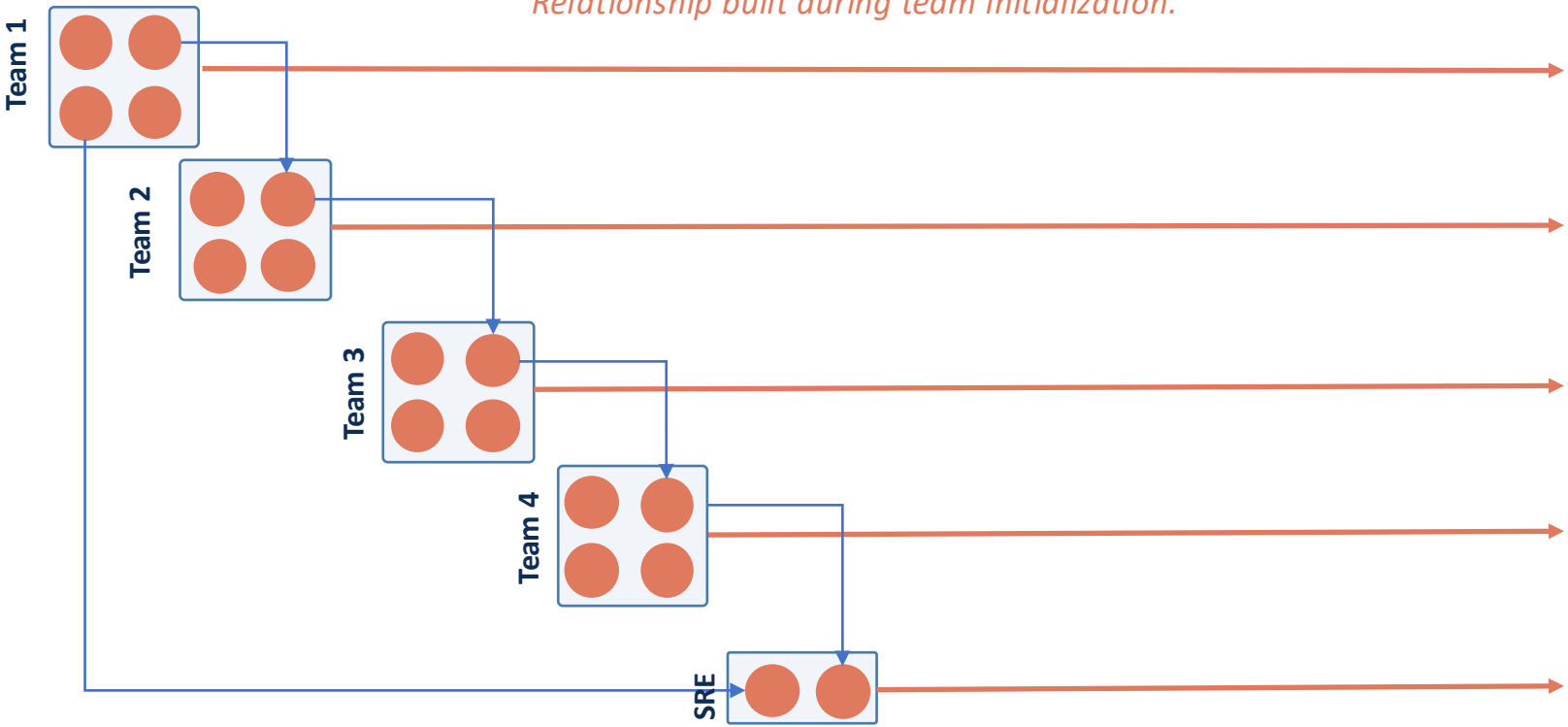
# *Two perspectives on the SRE experiment*

| | **Thomas expected / Strategy** *(Manager)* | **Katharina did** *(SRE)* |
|---|---|---|
| **Time split** | ~80% coding focus | Reduce toil, protect development time |
| **Product** | Shared responsibility | support teams toward self-sufficiency |
| **Work distribution** | Case-by-case work distribution | Check and adjust driven by business needs |

The initial strategy went through waves of iterative adjustments

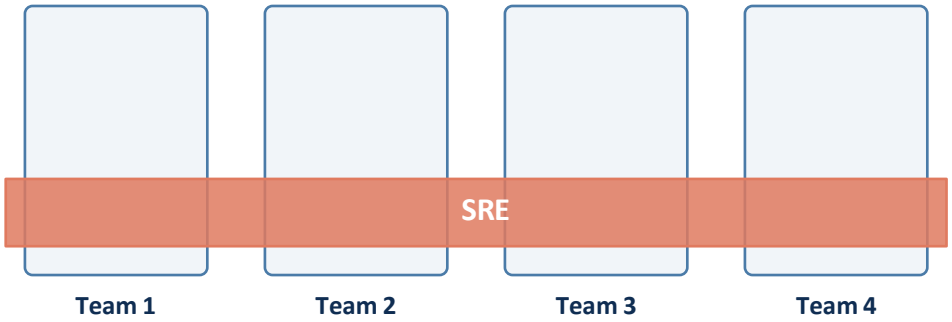
# *Embedded – during each lean inception*

*Relationship built during team initialization.*



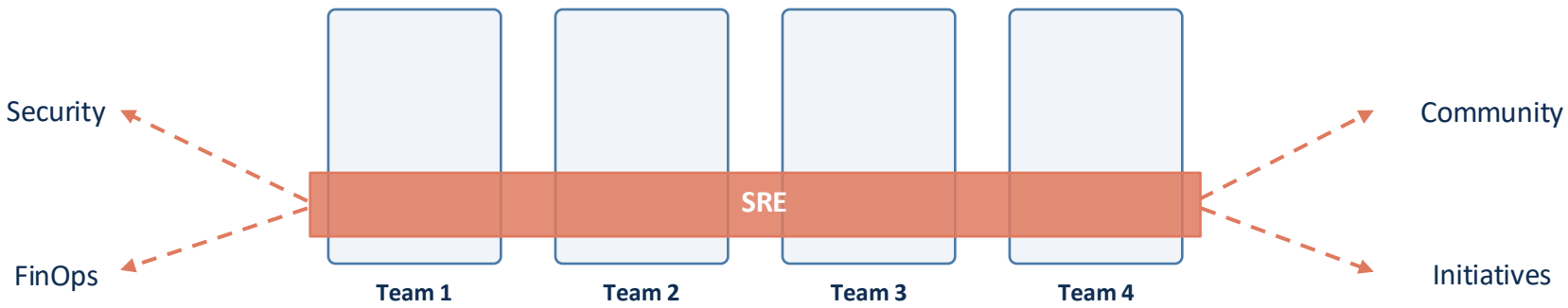
# *What we designed for*

The SRE function as a horizontal channel — connecting teams on SRE specific topics.




Independent Teams & SRE as channel between them

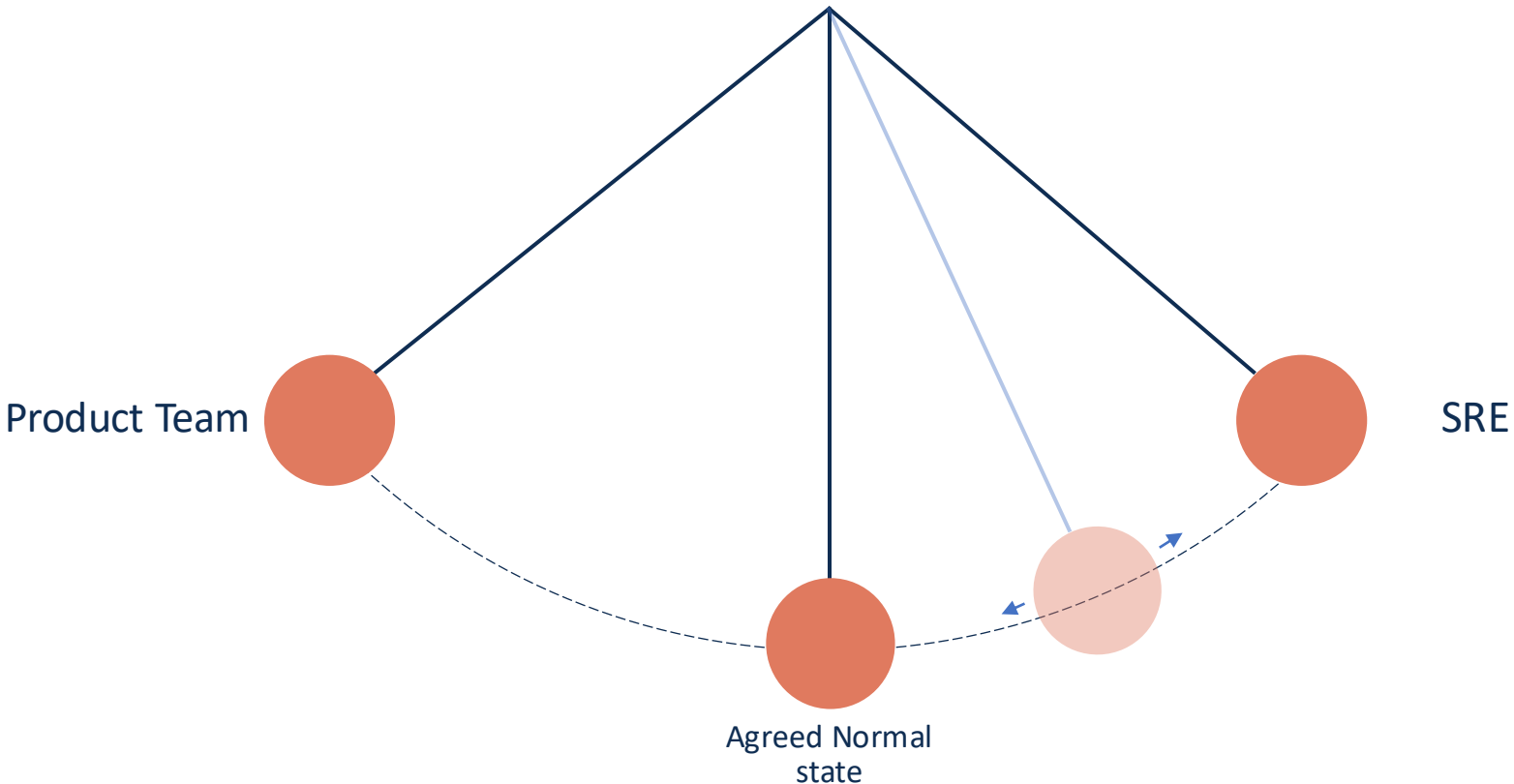
# *And then it became more*




SRE enabled alignment also for product development and initiatives – way broader scope!

# *The pendulum*

Workload could swing between product team and SRE team — by agreement, when needed.



# *Did the experiment work?*

*Yes!*

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| The pendulum | Boot strap new products in ~~days~~ hours | The team-to-team channel paid off |

# *Where we found the edges*

Overloaded Teams cannot engage

Non-synergetic products limit the impact

# *What you can take with you*

## Katharina — SRE's lens

- Culture over tooling
- Embed early, build trust
- Shared responsibility
- SRE as organizational bridge

## Thomas — manager's lens

- Your organization is a system
- Trust is a balance
- Match to a real business challenge
- Include exit and success strategy
- Experiments at organizational level

# Thank you

*We called it an experiment.*

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